STORYCAST

Research, Design and Technical Documentation

GitHub Repository: https://github.com/bonheurdivin/storycast
Figma Design: Figma Link

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1. Platform Overview

Storycast is a digital storytelling platform designed to share real life stories, integrate cultural heritage, and showcase personal experiences, difficulties, growth, and positive impact. Its moto, "*Real voices. Real stories. Shared understanding.*", explains the mentality that storytelling can have a real impact upon people's understanding about different perspectives and facilitate in developing greater empathy.

The microsite consists of 3 main pages: a **homepage** for discovering the main content, a featured **story page** for engaging with real personal stories, and an **About & Access** page defining the platform's mission, values, accessibility features, and different ways to access the mentioned testimonies. The featured story indicates the traditional Uyghur craft of making mulberry paper.

2. Problem Statement, Target Audience and User Goals

Problem Statement

People meet and read/listen to many stories online, but some of us do not always have a clear understanding regarding exploring cultural traditions, personal testimonies, or important community history. Many online platforms which carry them also become barriers for users who cannot or prefer not to rely solely on audio or video sources.

Storycast was designed to address all the above-mentioned concerns through creating a simple online tool with clear navigation, a dedicated story page, and many different ways to access the featured stories' content.

Target Audience

The storycast's main targeted audience includes youth, adults, students, and curious readers or listeners who feel interested in learning more about culture, personal testimonies, and positive change, as well as individuals who benefit mostly/solely from readable content, keyboard navigation, video captions, and text transcripts.

User Goals

The platform allows visitors to:

- Understand the main purpose of storycast.
- Access featured stories efficiently.
- Read/listen to personal stories and/or watch their respective videos.
- Easily get video captions and an appropriate text transcript.
- Navigate through the site using a keyboard and on different devices.

3. Research and Design Decisions

The microsite was planned around 3 main pages:

- **Home:** introduces the platform and presents featured stories.
- **Story Detail:** provides personal stories, their respective videos with captions, text transcript, and related overview.
- **About & Accessibility:** defines the site's mission & values, storytelling approach, and accessibility requirements.

Its approach consists of an editorial layout to present stories as the main focus. Consistent navigation, clear headings, and reusable cards facilitate visitors to navigate the platform and go through all pages.

Visual Design System

The visual style uses an easy, nature-inspired palette that supports efficient readability and a welcoming storytelling experience.

Design element	Value or choice
Background	Cream — #F8F7F2
Primary color	Forest green — #173F35
Secondary color	Sage — #E5EFE8
Supporting color	Pale green — #D9E4DC
Typography	Inter
Layout	CSS Grid and Flexbox
Components	Navigation, buttons, story cards, and footer

4. Technical Implementation

The project was designed with semantic HTML5, Sass (SCSS), CSS, and vanilla JavaScript without a frontend framework.

Sass is split into partials for colors, typography, and spacing, which are all imported into the main stylesheet. This structure allows platform styles consistency and makes future modifications easier.

CSS Grid and Flexbox facilitate in organizing page layouts. Responsive rules adapt content to numerous viewport sizes, while container queries provide relevant adjustments where appropriate.

JavaScript was used for small enhancements, such as modifying the footer year.

5. Accessibility and Inclusive Design

Accessibility was considered throughout the design and development process.

Area	Implementation
Structure	Semantic HTML and meaningful heading structure.

Keyboard use	Keyboard navigation and clear focus indicators
Video access	Efficient video controls, captions, and relevant transcripts.
Responsive access	Platform tested across mobile, tablet, and desktop screens.
Readability	Consistent typography, spacing, and color contrast specifications.

The website was checked manually for keyboard navigation and responsive behavior. These checks provide practical evidence of accessibility work but do not constitute formal WCAG certification.

6. Testing and Validation

Testing was carried out during development to identify layout, navigation, media, and markup issues.

Responsive Testing

The pages were checked at the following viewport sceens:

Device category	Result
Mobile phone	Passed
Tablet	Passed
Desktop	Passed

Functional and Accessibility Checks

- Navigation between all three pages was tested.
- Keyboard focus indicators and keyboard navigation were checked.
- Video playback and caption display were tested.
- The transcript file was checked.
- HTML validation was completed for all 3 pages.

7. Media Attribution and Limitations

The featured story uses a CGTN report about traditional Uyghur mulberry paper-making. The source and relevant attribution are mentioned in the references list below.

Storycast is a student project with one completed story and two featured-story placeholders marked as coming soon. The website has not been formally audited or certified for WCAG conformance.

8. Conclusion

Storycast shows how research, information architecture, visual design, semantic HTML, Sass, responsive CSS, and accessibility considerations can be combined to build a small storytelling platform.

The final design documentation should be read alongside the working website and repository. Together, they show the project's goals, design process, technical implementation, and testing evidence.

References

- Video source: CGTN, *Keeping Traditions Alive* — https://youtu.be/SNSnsp09Xis
- HTML validation: https://validator.w3.org/
- CSS validation: https://jigsaw.w3.org/css-validator/
- Accessibility reference: https://www.w3.org/WAI/standards-guidelines/wcag/